



Paws and Claws



In the animal kingdom, there are a lot of different paws and claws on feet. Some animals even have flippers for their feet!

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Polar bears have big paws and long, webbed claws. Their claws help them to hunt. Their claws can scoop up snow when they dig. The pads on their paws are non-slip and help them as they run on the snow.

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Lions have strong paws. Their front paws have five toes with five claws. This helps them grip and grab as they hunt. Lion claws can retract. They flex out when they need to. You will not see a claw mark in a lion's footprint.

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Goats can walk on steep hills and rocks. This is because they have a cloven hoof, split into two toes. The split lets the goat grip onto rocks.

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Look at this gecko. Geckos have foot pads on their feet. Foot pads grip and cling. The foot pads are like a magnet. Geckos can hang up and down on trees just like a spider can!

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Ducks have webbed feet. Webbed feet help a duck to swim and push down in the water.

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As you can see, we can learn about how an animal adapts to its environment by looking at its feet.

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